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Shackle, fetter, manacle

3.21.5 Shackle, fetter, manacle

References:

Hebrew כֶּבֶל (kevel) PSA 105:18, PSA 149:8

Hebrew נְחֹשֶׁת (nchosheth) JDG 16:21, 2SA 3:34, 2KI 25:7, 2CH 33:11, 2CH 36:6, JER 39:7, JER 52:11, LAM 3:7

Greek πέδη (pedē) MRK 5:4, MRK 5:4, LUK 8:29, SIR 6:29, SIR 21:19, 3MA 4:9, 3MA 6:19, SIR 6:24, SIR 33:29, 1MA 3:41

Greek χειροπέδη (cheiropedē) SIR 21:19

Description and usage:

Shackle for the ankles to restrict prisoner movement (Daderot, Public domain or CC0, via Wikimedia Commons)Fetters were metal chains with special links prepared to go around the ankles. They served to restrict the movement of someone considered dangerous or being imprisoned. There is considerable overlap between this entry and the preceding one on "chain." See also the illustration there.

Translation:

The equivalent in some languages for "fetters" is simply "chains on the feet." MRK 5:4 and LUK 8:29 refer to both chains and fetters. Fetters were used to bind the legs and feet and chains were used to bind the hands and arms. Where a specific word for "fetters" is not known, it is possible to render the literal phrase "bound with fetters and chains" as "put chains on his hands and feet."

The Old Testament text usually specifies the material of which the fetters or chains were made. The Hebrew word *nchosheth* refers to brass or bronze, while the two references to *kevel* in the Psalms are to instruments of iron.